

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 59 Summary

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In this video, Paul emphasizes the importance of learning Spanish verbs together with their correct prepositions—especially when they differ from English patterns. English speakers often struggle with this because Spanish sometimes uses prepositions where English doesn't, or uses a different preposition entirely. Rather than memorizing exhaustive lists, Paul focuses on high-frequency and practical verbs, using examples that reinforce natural usage and context.

1. Why Learn Verbs with Prepositions Together?

- Verbs often change meaning depending on the preposition used.
 - Some prepositions are required in Spanish even when none is used in English.
 - Example: *Soñar con* (to dream of) uses *con*, not *de* as English might suggest.
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2. The Verb "Soñar" (to dream)

- *Soñar con* alguien/algo: to dream of someone/something
 - *Juan sueña con ser abogado.*
 - *Anoche soñé con mi abuelo.*

Prepositions are always followed by the infinitive in Spanish, not the gerund (e.g., *con ser*, not *con siendo*).

3. "Pensar" + Prepositions

This verb changes meaning depending on its construction:

- *Pensar + infinitivo*: to plan to do something
 - *Pensamos mudarnos a México.*
- *Pensar en*: to think about something/someone
 - *Siempre pienso en ti.*
 - *¿En qué piensas?*
- *Pensar de*: to give an opinion about something
 - *¿Qué piensas del nuevo supervisor?*

- ¿Qué piensas?

Other ways to ask for opinions: ¿Qué opinas?, ¿Qué te parece?

4. Other Common Verb + Preposition Constructions

- *Enamorarse de*: to fall in love with
 - *María se enamoró de Julio a primera vista.*
 - *Despedirse de*: to say goodbye to
 - *Mi primo se despidió de nosotros antes de abordar el avión.*
 - Non-pronominal form *despedir* can mean to emit/give off or to fire someone
 - *La empresa despidió a 30 empleados.*
 - *Cansarse de*: to get tired of
 - *Juan se cansó de trabajar y se jubiló.*
 - *Burlarse de*: to make fun of
 - *Los estudiantes siempre se burlan de su profesor.*
 - *Burlar* alone can mean to evade or trick
 - *Limitarse a*: to limit oneself to
 - *El médico me dijo que debía limitarme a beber solo dos copas al día.*
 - *Invitar a*: to invite someone to do something
 - *Mi primo me invitó a cenar.*
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5. Verbs of Learning and Teaching

- *Aprender a + infinitive*: to learn to
 - *Aprendí a nadar a los cinco años.*
 - *Enseñar a + infinitive*: to teach to
 - *Mi padre me enseñó a nadar a los cinco años.*
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6. Verbs of Beginning

- *Empezar a / Comenzar a + infinitive*: to begin to
 - *Quiero comer antes de empezar a pintar la casa.*
 - *Pintar de + color*: to paint something a color
 - *Pintamos la casa de azul.*
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7. Other Useful Constructions

- *Ayudar a + infinitive*: to help someone to
 - *Avísame cuando puedas ayudarme a pintar la casa.*
 - This is a good example of combining triggers (*cuando*) with subjunctive (*puedas*) and correct preposition usage.
 - *Abusar de*: to abuse
 - *Juan abusa de su cuerpo.*
 - *Contar con*: to count on / to have
 - *Siempre puedes contar conmigo.*
 - *El hotel cuenta con más de 200 habitaciones.*
 - *Contar* alone can also mean to count numbers or tell a story.
 - *Depender de*: to depend on
 - *La duración del viaje depende del tráfico.*
 - Variation: *dependiendo de* (depending on)
 - *Dependiendo del día de la semana, el horario puede variar.*
 - *Acostumbrarse a*: to become accustomed to
 - *Los recién casados están aprendiendo a acostumbrarse a vivir juntos.*
 - *Quejarse de*: to complain about
 - *María se queja de todo.*
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Conclusion

Rather than memorizing disconnected lists, learners should study common Spanish verbs with their natural prepositional pairings and practice them in context. This approach helps internalize correct usage and avoids frequent translation errors caused by relying on English structures. Future lessons may categorize these by preposition, but understanding usage in real sentences is most effective for long-term retention.